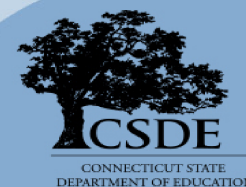


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



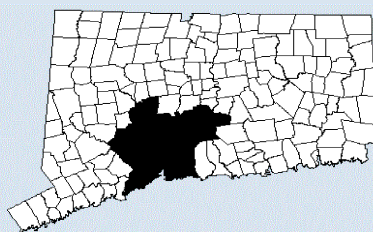
Area Cooperative Educational Services

203-498-6817 • www.aces.org

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	12
Enrollment	1,819
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$39,628
Total Expenditures ¹	\$84,447,804

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	764	42.0	48.5
Male	1,055	58.0	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	45	2.5	5.1
Black or African American	608	33.4	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	608	33.4	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	103	5.7	4.3
White	445	24.5	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	103	5.7	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,068	58.7	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	750	41.2	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	411	56.0	114	14.2
Male	592	58.2	228	20.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	328	55.3	158	24.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	395	67.5	107	16.5
White	199	46.7	54	11.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	65	64.4	16	14.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	711	66.2	249	21.0
Students with Disabilities	469	61.1	154	17.5
District	1,003	57.2	342	17.6
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 251

Number of school-based arrests: 17

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	109.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	26.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	92.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	338.6
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	12.0
School Level	17.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	19.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	32.0
School Nurses	15.6
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	176.4

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.7	1.3
Black or African American	17	5.7	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	14	4.7	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	263	88.9	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.6	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	6	*	17	43.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	7	22.6
White	*	*	7	14.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	14	42.4	*	*
Students with Disabilities	14	28.6	36	28.6
District	14	28.6	36	28.6
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.1
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.3
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$41,145,905	\$19,308	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$16,217,419	\$7,610	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$2,510,329	\$1,178	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$4,221,451	\$1,981	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$4,256,259	\$1,997	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$5,350,263	\$2,511	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,933,327	\$3,254	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$3,812,853	\$1,941	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$170
Total	\$84,447,804	\$39,628	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$9,517,494	19.0	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$7,282,433	14.6	10.8
Other Salaries	\$15,590,494	31.2	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$11,120,716	22.2	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,247,766	2.5	5.7
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.6
Supplies	\$1,748,956	3.5	0.6
Property Services	\$2,279,823	4.6	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$32,736	0.1	6.3
Equipment	\$1,158,262	2.3	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$7,166	0.0	0.1
Total	\$49,985,846	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		59.2	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	80.6
State	17.6
Federal	1.8
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	409	49.9	399	40.4	149	46.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	454	54.2	453	44.4	155	49.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	73	56.8	73	43.8	19	*
White	291	59.4	290	51.0	79	56.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	112	50.9	112	44.9	41	48.3
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,145	54.5	1,133	44.8	375	50.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	728	50.8	719	41.0	251	47.3
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	529	58.9	526	50.1	165	55.5
Students with Disabilities	388	36.8	380	30.4	141	38.2
Students without Disabilities	869	62.0	865	51.1	275	57.0
High Needs	894	49.2	883	40.3	307	46.4
Non-High Needs	363	66.6	362	55.7	109	62.3
District	1,257	54.2	1,245	44.8	416	50.6

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	70.7	79.1	76.2	35.3	713	74.9
Curl Up	70.7	77.2	73.3	32.4	713	72.8
Push Up	67.1	62.7	62.6	32.4	713	61.7
Mile Run/PACER	70.7	74.7	52.3	32.4	713	63.4
All Tests - District	52.4	48.7	39.9	23.5	713	44.5
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	N/A	N/A
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	N/A	N/A
Students with Disabilities	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	21.4	0	0.0
Male	33.8	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	46.2	0	0.0
Hispanic or Latino	16.7	0	0.0
White	24.3	*	*
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	38.1	*	*
Students with Disabilities	30.9	*	*
District	30.9	*	*
State	95.0		43.5

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	*	*
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	*	*
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	*	*
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	54.2	75	36.1	50	72.3	64.2
	High Needs Students	49.2	75	32.8	50	65.6	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	44.8	75	29.9	50	59.7	58.6
	High Needs Students	40.3	75	26.9	50	53.8	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	50.6	75	33.7	50	67.5	61.4
	High Needs Students	46.4	75	31.0	50	61.9	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	52.0%	100%	52.0	100	52.0	60.4%
	High Needs Students	51.8%	100%	51.8	100	51.8	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	48.9%	100%	48.9	100	48.9	65.2%
	High Needs Students	46.3%	100%	46.3	100	46.3	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	68.8%	100%	34.4	50	68.8	64.9%
	Oral	61.9%	100%	30.9	50	61.9	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	57.2%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	23.7%
	High Needs Students	62.1%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	28.6%	75%	19.0	50	38.1	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	0.6%	75%	0.4	50	0.8	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		80.7%	94%	42.9	50	85.9	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		10.3%	75%	13.7	100	13.7	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		86.3% 44.5%	75%	14.8	50	29.6	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		13.6%	60%	11.3	50	22.7	52.4%
Accountability Index				557.0	1250	44.6	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	66.6	49.2	17.4	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	55.7	40.3	15.4	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	62.3	46.4	15.9	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	97.5
	High Needs Students	96.7
Math	All Students	96.4
	High Needs Students	95.4
Science	All Students	92.5
	High Needs Students	90.7

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 38.6

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Area Cooperative Educational Services (ACES) is the Regional Educational Service Center in south-central Connecticut dedicated to enhancing and transforming lives through education, innovation, and leadership. Our vision is to create an equitable and socially just world, one life at a time, by engaging the community through Open and Magnet School Parent Choice programs and Minority Teacher Recruitment initiatives.

We offer behavior services for individuals on the autism spectrum, occupational & physical therapy, professional development, and technology services.

Initiatives that focus on developing community relationships provide transition opportunities for students from our high school program to gain experience in office support at local churches while developing community experience by volunteering at local animal shelters. The Integrated Preschool program offers an active, supportive learning environment in which special needs children and typical peers learn together through developmentally appropriate theme-based activities and experiences. The curriculum is based on the Preschool Common Core State Standards and the Connecticut Early Learning and Development Standards. Schools also assess and provide training around pre-vocational and community skills for students. Mentoring programs and after-school clubs or activities for students with autism facilitate social skills and leisure skills. Staff participates in training in trauma-informed interventions focused on relationships, safety, therapeutic interventions and coping skills to support students facing multiple mental health challenges. Ongoing training focuses on addressing reading difficulties that impact the academic setting. Technology engages students in developing academic and social skills as they utilize Smartboards to show their skills in the area of broadcasting and reporting.

Truancy impacts all populations and ages. The ACES Truancy Intervention Committee engages in activities focused on getting students to school. Schools utilize various strategies that include the development of committees to review data to determine trends and patterns and make recommendations on ways to engage families and students proactively.

Family engagement promotes participation in school-based committees such as the Parent-Teacher Coalition. Parents are encouraged to plan and implement activities such as student presentations of Project-Based Learning projects, Open House, creation of a Facebook page, parent training for students on the spectrum, IEP development and implementation, Game Night, Harvest Festival, and Prom.

ACES has hired a Family and Community Engagement Specialist who proactively plans activities for families and assists families in identifying outside resources to address their needs. ACES has developed a technology training program for parents to support families working at home with their children during periods of virtual or distance instruction.

Collaborative programs supported integrating special needs students with typical peers in their home school. The high school program at West Haven and Ansonia offers more opportunities for inclusion and integration with typical peers.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

As a Regional Educational Service Center, ACES works with our 25-member school districts to reduce academic and social issues stemming from racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. To reduce racial isolation, ACES operates three interdistrict magnet schools enrolling over 1600 students, coordinates several interdistrict collaborative programs, and facilitates Open Choice for our districts.

ACES magnet schools are designed to attract students across many school districts increasing educational opportunities for students of diverse backgrounds to learn alongside one another. Each school reinforces its diversity mission while delivering a high-quality curriculum with a unique academic focus.

Technology allows students to access their learning through multiple resources and has been said to be a great divide for student learning. We provide state-of-the-art technical support and services for all our students to assist them in their education in person and remotely. Most of our schools offer their students a one-to-one laptop/iPad experience. We are working with local universities to develop laboratory classrooms to support action research in our schools and to support the development of teacher cohorts for our member school districts. Our magnet schools have also had the opportunity to participate with other school districts in the interdistrict grant partnerships. Here, our schools' teachers and students work with fellow schools from other communities. We seek opportunities to partner for technology, math, social studies, science, and Language Arts enrichment.

ACES has been instrumental in Minority Teacher Recruitment (MTR) efforts in CT. The MTR Advisory Council has developed and implemented strategies to increase the number of minority educators, including our highly successful annual MTR Job Fair. As a member of the RESC MTR Alliance, ACES played a crucial role in securing funding from the State Pipeline. ACES now operates a Teacher Residency Program to attract and retain teachers of color.

ACES has an agency-wide Diversity Committee and has hired a Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Director to provide DEI leadership across the agency.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

ACES is the Regional Educational Service Center for twenty-five school districts in south-central Connecticut. Each local school district appoints a representative to the ACES Governing Board of Education. Our Board works collectively to set a strategic direction for our organization based on the region's educational needs and our school system. ACES operates schools and programs based on these needs, and the Governing Board ensures the equitable allocation of resources among the programs. Each school and program participate in a rigorous budget development process, including ACES Governing Board Approval of resource allocations in every program.

Local funding, State of Connecticut magnet school support, and grant resources are utilized to achieve and enhance equity among our programs. Building level principals and directors meet monthly with ACES Central Administration to discuss issues relating to available resources in meeting their academic goals. This process also assists the district and agency plan for budget development. The budget process includes a committee, the building administrator(s), ACES Central Administration, and the ACES Governing Board.